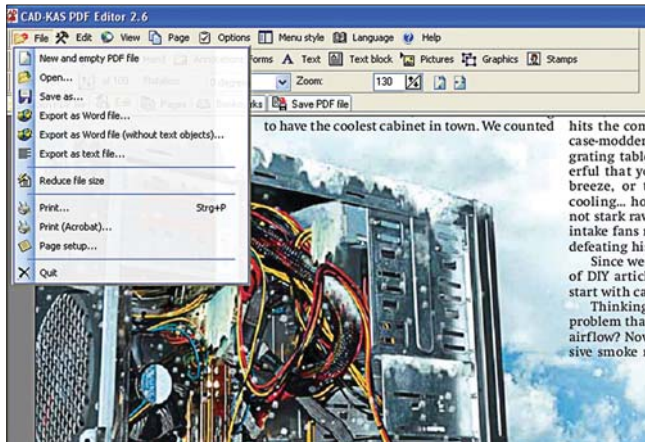


CAD-KAS PDF Editor 2.6

Tricky!



The need for a PDF Editor usually means you end up buying a copy of Adobe Acrobat. There are a few paid applications to do the same task. CAD-KAS's PDF Editor 2.4 is one such application among a few other emerging ones.

The interface is modular; it allows you to add and remove or even move panels around. It is a

little cluttered, with the top end of the window taken up by the two toolbars and the tab bar, which are used to do the majority of the tasks—opening, editing, exporting, etc. Although looks aren't a priority in software such as this, six menu colour schemes have been included as a way to improve the cluttered UI.

One can change pretty

much everything in an existing PDF file. Text, images, and even complete pages can be edited and moved about. New additions can be made easily in the same manner. Images in PDFs can be edited using the inbuilt image editor—which looks like MS Paint, but is a lot more advanced in features. A scanner can be used to add new pages. Bookmarks can be set, and existing ones deleted if required.

CAD-KAS PDF Editor allows you to save PDF files in different PDF versions, and also encrypt and protect them from being edited or even viewed if required. One of the missing features is the ability to export a Web page into the PDF format.

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Exporting to Word files and text files is supported, though.

The way you use the software is a little different from what you're used to. You need to first select the tool and then select the text or image that you're trying to alter. Double-clicking doesn't enable any kind of editing mode. There is no live preview of all the tasks done—on images for example. Users will take a while to get used to all this. The help file has sketchy documentation with the most basic explanations, and contains just a few screenshots.

CAD-KAS PDF Editor skimps on some of the features Acrobat gives you, but it is way cheaper—just \$79. Ignore the tiny missing features, and it's a great tool for anyone who needs to create documentation or distribute important documents.

Web site: www.cadkas.com

Price: \$79 (Rs 3,200)

ACDSee 2 Pro

Lightroom's new competitor

ACDSee is an image viewer that's been well known since the days of IrfanView. ACDSee had quite a few followers for its superior features back then, but IrfanView was generally known more for being freeware. ACDSee 2 Pro has moved from being just an image viewer. This new version boasts of great photo handling features for the professional photographer.

The first thing ACDSee 2 Pro does is catalogue all your images when you first run it. The interface is surrounded by sidebars, leaving only a small area to actually view images and the thumbnails.

Photos are sorted by time and can be viewed through the Calendar view. The other useful filtering feature is the Organise sidebar, which allows you to

display photos from only a particular camera. A quick preview appears when you hover the pointer over an image. You can enter image editing mode by double-clicking on any of the photos. ACDSee 2 Pro even loads videos; you can not only view them, but also convert them using the codecs on your machine.

Images and videos can even be burnt onto CD and DVD. Wizards are available to create video CDs as well. Other than that, you can even export your photos as HTML albums, PDF, or PowerPoint presentations.

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



Memory consumption was well under 30 MB while browsing images, and only spiked by a few (5 to 10) MB while opening images.

Other than its clumsy interface, ACDSee 2 Pro seems a nice software, until you get to know about the price tag—\$129.99. It's still much cheaper than Adobe Lightroom, which is more than twice its price. It has quite a few features that can

be compared to those of Lightroom, but it doesn't match its simplicity.

People looking for image viewers can stick to free ones like IrfanView, as ACDSee 2 Pro has gone far beyond that. Users who can't afford Lightroom might want to consider ACDSee 2 Pro.

Web site: www.acdsee.com

Price: \$129.99 (Rs 5,200)